

Troubleshooting Software -- Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit 4.3 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. Core 2 5.3 | N10-008

For instructor use / distribute after students complete the notes.

Question 1

Safe Mode starts Windows with only _____ drivers and services loaded. This is useful for diagnosing software issues because malware and problematic drivers are _____ to load. Safe Mode with Networking adds _____ support. Safe Mode is accessed by holding _____ while clicking Restart.

Answer: Minimal (essential); unable (prevented); network; Shift.

Question 2

A BCD error message ('Boot Configuration Data file is missing or contains errors') means the Windows _____ store is damaged. The command _____ is run from WinRE Command Prompt to rebuild it. The WinRE command bootrec _____ repairs the master boot record, and bootrec _____ repairs the boot sector.

Answer: Boot configuration data (BCD); bootrec /rebuildbcd; /fixmbr; /fixboot.

Question 3

Startup Repair is a WinRE tool that automatically scans for and fixes common problems preventing Windows from _____. It is located under Troubleshoot > _____ Options in WinRE. Startup Repair can fix issues such as missing system files, boot manager errors, and _____ configuration.

Answer: Starting (booting); Advanced; BCD (boot).

Question 4

When Windows crashes with a BSOD, it writes a mini crash report called a _____ file to the folder _____. These files can be analyzed with tools such as WinDbg or _____ to identify the driver or component that caused the crash. The analysis typically shows a _____ name linked to the failure.

Answer: Minidump; C:\Windows\Minidump; BlueScreenView (or WinDbg Preview); driver or module.

Question 5

BSOD stop codes are displayed in _____ format. A stop code of 0x0000007E means SYSTEM THREAD EXCEPTION NOT _____. A stop code of 0x000000EF means _____ Process Died. When researching a stop code, the technician should record the _____ hexadecimal value and search the Microsoft documentation for it.

Answer: Hexadecimal; HANDLED; Critical; full.

Question 6

When diagnosing slow Windows performance, the three columns to examine in Task Manager's Processes tab are _____, _____, and _____. A process using 100% of any column is the _____ and should be investigated. Disk at 100% on an HDD system often indicates the OS is using the _____ heavily.

Answer: CPU; Memory; Disk; bottleneck; page file (virtual memory).

Question 7

If a device stops working after a Windows Update installs a new driver, a technician can use _____ Manager to roll back the driver. Right-clicking the device and selecting _____ opens the properties dialog, where the _____ Driver button returns to the previously working version.

Answer: Device; Properties; Roll Back.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A user reports that Windows boots to the login screen, they enter their password, and then the desktop loads briefly before logging them out automatically and showing a 'temporary profile' notification. They have noticed this for the last two days. Identify the problem, explain what is causing it, and describe the complete repair procedure.

Answer: The problem is a corrupted user profile. When Windows cannot load the primary user profile (profile hive is locked or corrupted), it falls back to a temporary profile that is discarded on logout -- all changes are lost. Cause: often a result of a crash or improper shutdown during a Windows Update that was writing to the registry hive. Repair: Step 1 -- Log in as a different administrator account (or use Safe Mode). Step 2 -- Open Registry Editor (regedit) and navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\ProfileList. Step 3 -- Find the entry for the affected user profile (it may have a .bak extension on the SID key). Rename the .bak entry to remove .bak, and if two entries exist for the same SID, delete the non-.bak one. Step 4 -- Reboot and log in normally -- Windows will reload the original profile. Step 5 -- Back up the fixed profile and document the repair.